

Market Outlook

For
March 2026



Buy on the sound of cannons, sell on the sound of trumpets

The global equity markets displayed a mixed performance in February 2026, with regional divergences becoming more pronounced. US equities remained under pressure, dragged down by weakness in mega-cap technology, which continued to face investor concerns around escalating AI-related capex cycles and their impact on return on invested capital. This sell-off was broad within the large-cap technology cohort, with 6 out of the mag-7 names declining through the month, reflecting heightened anxiety over AI disruption risks and the sustainability of elevated spending commitments. On the other hand, European and select Asian equity markets continued to move higher, supported by broadening earnings expectations, rotation into value and cyclical, and improving macro signals across key economies.

While global equity markets were already jittery through February, geopolitical tensions escalated late in the month, further unsettling investor sentiment. The co-ordinated U.S. and Israeli military strikes against Iran, intensified global risk aversion and reinforced a broad risk-off shift across markets. This escalation prompted investors to seek safety, driving traditional havens higher. Gold continued its strong upward trajectory, rising more than 10% and marking a seventh consecutive monthly gain, while the US Dollar Index also strengthened as capital rotated into defensive positioning. At the same time, oil prices climbed, with Brent extending the gains made earlier in the year. The move higher was driven by heightened geopolitical uncertainty in the Middle East and concerns about potential supply disruptions, pushing Brent crude toward the mid \$80s per barrel range after building on January's strong gains.

Up until geopolitical tensions escalated and further weighed on sentiment, Indian market performance remained relatively subdued. The defining event of the month was an unprecedented collapse in the IT sector, with five of India's largest technology companies declining 15–22% MoM, triggered by Anthropic's launch of Claude Cowork and associated automation tools—an announcement that sparked global “SaaSpocalypse”-style fears over AI-driven disruption. The Nifty IT index registered its worse monthly decline of 20% in nearly two decades.

In contrast, PSU banks stood out as clear outperformers, buoyed by strong earnings momentum and aided by a sectoral rotation away from technology and toward financials, metals, defence, and other public-sector lenders. The broader market also fared better, with both the mid-cap and small-cap indices closing the month firmly in the green.

February also featured three major macro policy events within its first week, making it arguably the most consequential policy month of the year. In our view, the Union Budget 2026 marked another step toward stimulating growth while maintaining fiscal discipline. The government targeted a fiscal deficit of 4.3% for FY27E, compared with 4.4% for FY26E—implying calibrated consolidation while ensuring ongoing support to the economy. Capital expenditure was projected to rise by 11.5%, with increased allocations toward sunrise sectors such as semiconductors (₹40,000 crore) and defence (up nearly 20%), signalling the government's continued focus on infrastructure, self-reliance and strategic capability building. Tax-revenue assumptions for FY27E were kept conservative, reflecting prudence in fiscal planning.

Additionally, the India–US trade agreement reduced effective tariffs from 50% to 18% by removing the Russian-oil surcharge, helping ease import-cost pressures. The RBI maintained its policy rate at 5.25% after cumulative cuts of 125 bps, reaffirmed its stance on proactive liquidity management with a system surplus of approximately ₹75,000 crore, and revised FY26 GDP growth upward to 7.4%. While policy-neutral overall, this backdrop provided stability and a floor for rate-sensitive sectors through what was otherwise a turbulent month.

Equity market outlook

We remain constructive on Indian equities, as highlighted in our earlier factsheets, supported by a compelling combination of fiscal, monetary, and regulatory easing that is poised to drive growth. The recently concluded trade agreement with the US, together with a more optimistic earnings outlook, is expected to reinforce domestic investor sentiment and has already helped moderate FII selling pressure. Although ongoing geopolitical tensions continue to elevate market volatility, we view these risks as largely short-term and believe they provide opportunities for selective, fundamentals-driven investments.

At the same time, India's resilient macroeconomic backdrop continues to offer a strong foundation for equity performance. We expect broader markets to participate more meaningfully in CY26, following nearly 15 months of relative underperformance. In our view, this could be a period where mid-cap and small-cap segments outperform, reinforcing our preference for a multicap strategy. Our investment approach will remain firmly bottom-up and anchored in our GARP (Growth at a Reasonable Price) philosophy, ensuring disciplined stock selection while capturing opportunities across market capitalisations.

Fixed Income overview:

Bond markets have seen selling pressure, weighed down by the excess supply concerns post the higher-than-expected announcement of gross borrowing of Rs17.2 tn. Also, sentiment further deteriorated post upward revision of the GDP and inflation reading by the MPC in its Feb meeting dashed hopes of any scope for further rate cuts in this cycle. There was no additional measure announced for the liquidity in the MPC meeting.

However, the announcement of the India-US trade deal, switches conducted of the RBI holdings and market securities maturing in FY 2027 reducing gross supply and secondary OMO purchases from RBI turned sentiments positive.

The US-Israeli attack on Iran has destabilized the Middle East, led to spike in energy prices. Its impact on India inflation and CAD will be critical.

	Feb-26	Jan-26	Dec-25
IGB 10 Yr	6.66	6.70	6.59
IGB 5 Yr	6.28	6.41	6.31
IGB 30 Yr	7.34	7.36	7.27
US 10 Yr	3.94	4.24	4.17

Fixed Income Outlook:

There is heavy supply of SDL still hitting the market but with RBI coming back in the secondary market and G-sec auctions taking a pause for 3 weeks, market is expected to remain supportive in short term. Also, going ahead with demand supply situation evolving favourably we remain constructive on bond market. Risk to our view is of further escalation of geopolitical tension in middle east.

FUTURE GROUP SECURE FUND

SFIN No. ULGF007010118GRPSECFUND133

ABOUT THE FUND

OBJECTIVE
This fund aims to provide progressive returns compared to fixed income instruments by taking a low exposure to high risk assets like equity. Fund aims to provide stable return due to high exposure to Fixed Income instruments while generating additional return through small exposure to equity.

Fund Manager Details

Fund Manager	No. Of Funds Managed		
	Equity	Debt	Hybrid
Srijan Sinha	6	-	7
Vedant Heda	-	4	7
Shobit Gupta	-	4	7
Niraj Kumar	6	4	7

ASSET ALLOCATION

Composition	Min.	Max.	Actual
Cash and Money Market	0.00%	40.00%	2.58%
Fixed Income Instruments	60.00%	100.00%	78.60%
Equities	0.00%	20.00%	18.81%

RISK RETURN PROFILE

Risk	Low To Moderate
Return	High

DATE OF INCEPTION

19th December 2018

FUND PERFORMANCE as on 27-Feb-2026

Returns since Publication of NAV	
Absolute Return	110.76%
CAGR Return	10.91%

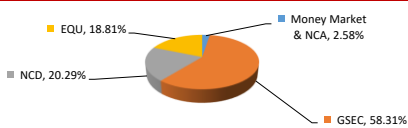
NAV & AUM as on 27-Feb-2026

NAV	AUM (In Lakhs)
21.0760	7,861.87

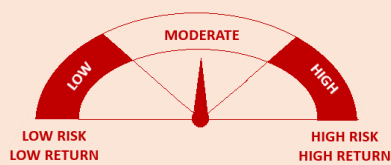
Modified Duration (In Years)

6.00

ASSET ALLOCATION



MODERATE RISK MODERATE RETURN



PORTFOLIO AS ON 27-Feb-2026

SECURITIES	HOLDINGS
MONEY MARKET INSTRUMENTS & NCA	2.58%

SECURITIES

GOVERNMENT SECURITIES	HOLDINGS
0% CS 19/12/2029	9.07%
6.48% Govt. Stock 2035	6.86%
7.24% Gsec 18 Aug 2055	6.39%
0% CS 19/12/2030	5.07%
6.90% Gsec 15/04/2065	5.00%
0% CS 15/06/2030	4.98%
7.43% GSEC 19 Jan 2076	4.48%
0% CS 19/12/2033	3.56%
0% CS 17/06/2033	2.52%
7.10% GOI Sovereign Green Bond 27/01/2028	2.44%
Others	7.96%

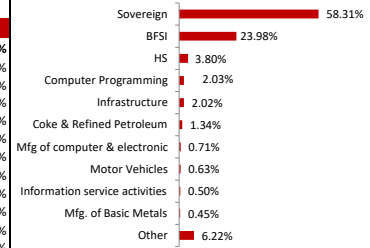
SECURITIES

CORPORATE DEBT	HOLDINGS
9.09% Muthoot Finance Ltd 01/06/2029	20.29%
9.00% Shriram Transport Finance Company Ltd 28/03/2028	6.65%
7.89% Bajaj Housing Finance Ltd 14/07/2034	3.93%
9.30% AU Small Finance Bank Ltd 13/08/2032	3.80%
8.85% HD8 Fin. Services Ltd 07/06/2029 Sub debt	2.73%
8.40% Cholamandalam Investment And Fin Co Ltd 09/08/2028	1.20%
8.94% Power Finance Corporation Ltd 25/03/2028	0.79%
10.63% IOT Utkal Energy Services Ltd 2028 20/07/2028	0.66%
8.90% BHARTI TELECOM Ltd 05/11/2031	0.41%
	0.13%

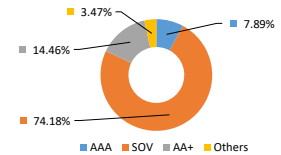
SECURITIES

EQUITY	HOLDINGS
HDFC Bank Ltd	18.81%
ICICI Bank Ltd	1.67%
Reliance Industries Ltd	1.30%
Axis Bank Ltd	1.00%
Infosys Technologies Ltd.	0.84%
State Bank of India	0.79%
Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd	0.76%
Kotak Nifty PSU Bank ETF	0.69%
Tata Consultancy Services Ltd	0.58%
Bharti Airtel Ltd. (Partly Paid)	0.49%
Fusion Finance Ltd	0.45%
Indusind Bank Ltd	0.45%
Nagarjuna Construction Co. Ltd	0.39%
ITC Ltd	0.33%
Mahindra And Mahindra Ltd	0.30%
Genus Power Infrastructure Ltd	0.30%
ETERNAL Ltd (Zomato Ltd)	0.30%
Nippon India ETF Nifty PSU Bank BeES	0.29%
Bank of Baroda	0.29%
Punjab National Bank	0.29%
Equitas Small Finance Bank Ltd	0.27%
Anant Raj Ltd	0.26%
Swiggy Ltd	0.26%
PB FINTECH Ltd	0.26%
Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd	0.25%
Others	5.75%

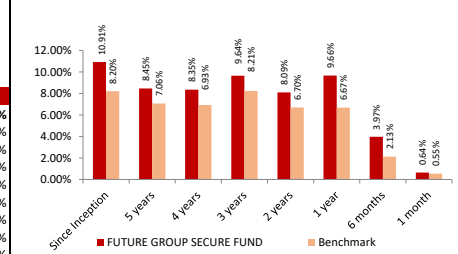
SECTORAL ALLOCATION



Debt Rating Profile

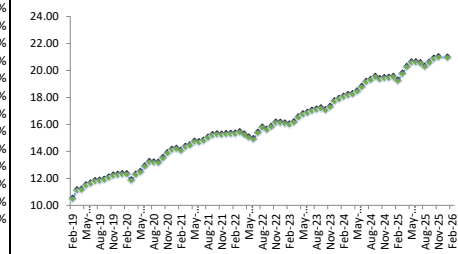


BENCHMARK COMPARISON (CAGR RETURN)



Benchmark : Nifty Composite Debt Index 85%+Nifty 50-15%

FUND - NAV



FUTURE GROUP GROWTH FUND

SFIN No. ULGF009010118GRPETHFUND133

ABOUT THE FUND

OBJECTIVE
This fund aims to provide potentially high returns by investing a significant portion in equities to target growth in capital value of assets. The fund will also invest to a certain extent in govt. securities, corporate bonds and money market instruments to generate stable return.

Fund Manager Details

Fund Manager	No. Of Funds Managed		
	Equity	Debt	Hybrid
Srijan Sinha	6	-	7
Vedant Heda	-	4	7
Shobit Gupta	-	4	7
Niraj Kumar	6	4	7

ASSET ALLOCATION

Composition	Min.	Max.	Actual
Cash and Money Market	0.00%	40.00%	4.31%
Fixed Income Instruments	30.00%	70.00%	37.99%
Equities	30.00%	60.00%	57.70%

RISK RETURN PROFILE

Risk	Low To Moderate
Return	High

DATE OF INCEPTION

10th December 2020

FUND PERFORMANCE as on 27-Feb-2026

Returns since Publication of NAV	
Absolute Return	84.87%
CAGR Return	12.49%

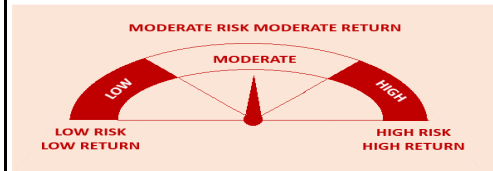
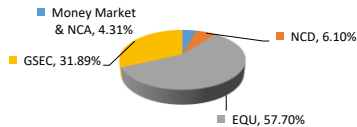
NAV & AUM as on 27-Feb-2026

NAV	AUM (In Lakhs)
18.4865	3,423.68

Modified Duration (In Years)

6.79

ASSET ALLOCATION

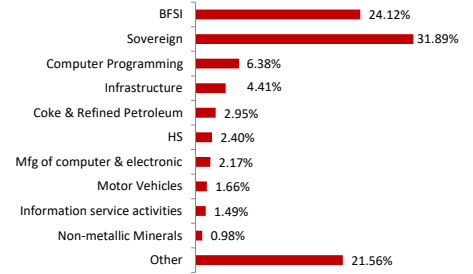


PORTFOLIO AS ON 27-Feb-2026

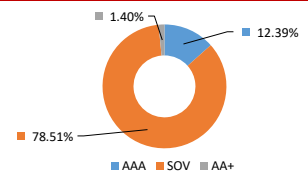
SECURITIES	HOLDINGS
MONEY MARKET INSTRUMENTS & NCA	4.31%
SECURITIES	HOLDINGS
GOVERNMENT SECURITIES	31.89%
6.01% Gsec 21 July 2030	8.83%
6.48% Govt. Stock 2035	4.64%
7.43% GSEC 19 Jan 2076	4.41%
7.24% Gsec 18 Aug 2055	3.61%
6.90% Gsec 15/04/2065	3.28%
7.38% UP SDL 13/03/2036	2.91%
0% CS 15/06/2030	0.96%
0% CS 17/06/2033	0.90%
0% CS 22/02/2030	0.89%
0% CS 19/12/2029	0.65%
Others	0.80%

SECURITIES	HOLDINGS
CORPORATE DEBT	6.10%
9.30% AU Small Finance Bank Ltd 13/08/2032	3.13%
7.89% Bajaj Housing Finance Ltd 14/07/2034	2.40%
8.40% Cholamandalam Investment And Fin Co Ltd 09/08/2028	0.57%

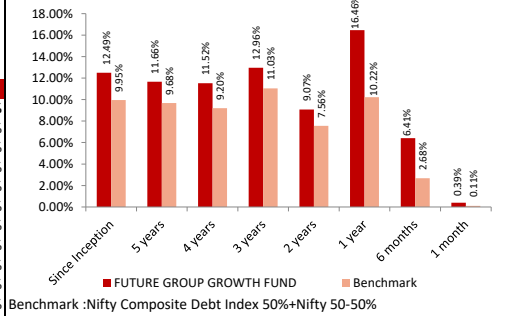
SECTORAL ALLOCATION



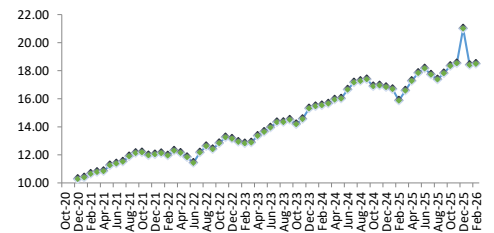
Debt Rating Profile



BENCHMARK COMPARISON (CAGR RETURN)



FUND - NAV



GROUP BALANCED FUND

SFIN No. ULGF008010118GRPBALFUND133

ABOUT THE FUND

OBJECTIVE
This fund aims to provide capital growth by availing opportunities in debt and equity markets while maintaining a good balance between risk and return. The fund will also invest in money market instruments to provide liquidity.

Fund Manager Details

Fund Manager	No. Of Funds Managed		
	Equity	Debt	Hybrid
Srijan Sinha	6	-	7
Vedant Heda	-	4	7
Shobit Gupta	-	4	7
Niraj Kumar	6	4	7

ASSET ALLOCATION

Composition	Min.	Max.	Actual
Cash and Money Market	0.00%	40.00%	11.46%
Fixed Income Instruments	40.00%	80.00%	50.45%
Equities	20.00%	40.00%	38.09%

RISK RETURN PROFILE

Risk		Low To Moderate
Return		Moderate

DATE OF INCEPTION

27th November 2024

FUND PERFORMANCE as on

27-Feb-2026

Returns since Publication of NAV

Absolute Return	10.57%
CAGR Return	8.38%

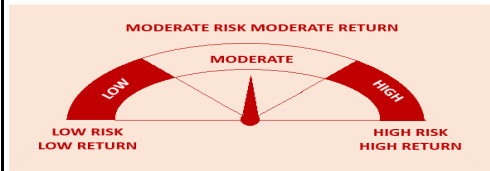
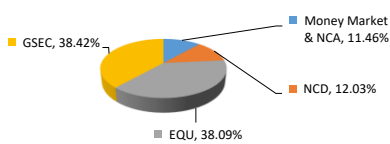
NAV & AUM as on 27-Feb-2026

NAV	AUM (In Lakhs)
11.0570	691.20

Modified Duration (In Years)

5.34

ASSET ALLOCATION



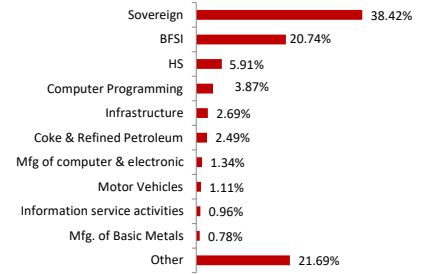
PORTFOLIO AS ON 27-Feb-2026

SECURITIES	HOLDINGS
MONEY MARKET INSTRUMENTS & NCA	11.46%

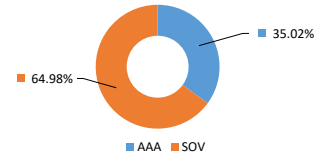
SECURITIES	HOLDINGS
GOVERNMENT SECURITIES	38.42%
0% CS 22/04/2035	23.73%
6.01% Gsec 21 July 2030	9.32%
0% Cs 19 Jun 2033	2.06%
6.48% Govt. Stock 2035	1.43%
8.15% TN SDL 09/05/2028	1.42%
8.68% TN SDL 10/10/2028	0.46%

SECURITIES	HOLDINGS
CORPORATE DEBT	12.03%
8.90% BHARTI TELECOM Ltd 05/11/2031	6.12%
7.87% LIC Housing Finance Ltd 14/05/2029	5.91%

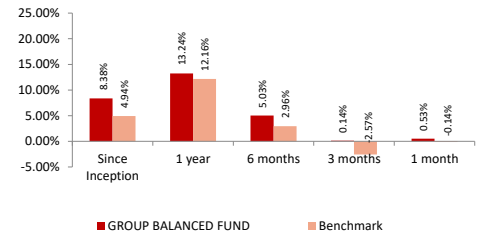
SECTORAL ALLOCATION



Debt Rating Profile

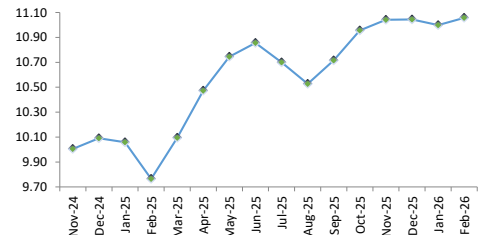


BENCHMARK COMPARISON (CAGR RETURN)



Benchmark : Nifty Composite Debt Index 70%+Nifty 50-30%

FUND - NAV



SECURITIES	HOLDINGS
EQUITY	38.09%
DSP Mutual Fund - DSP Nifty PSU Bank ETF	2.94%
HDFC Bank Ltd	2.86%
Axis Bank Ltd	2.22%
ICICI Bank Ltd	1.87%
SBI-ETF Nifty Bank	1.83%
Reliance Industries Ltd	1.82%
Infosys Technologies Ltd.	1.49%
IDFC First Bank Ltd	1.30%
Tata Consultancy Services Ltd	1.01%
State Bank of India	1.00%
Fusion Finance Ltd	0.99%
IndusInd Bank Ltd	0.82%
Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd	0.80%
Bharti Airtel Ltd. (Partly Paid)	0.80%
ITC Ltd	0.70%
Anant Raj Ltd	0.66%
Punjab National Bank	0.62%
Bank of Baroda	0.61%
ETERNAL Ltd (Zomato Ltd)	0.58%
Nagarjuna Construction Co. Ltd	0.56%
Genus Power Infrastructure Ltd	0.55%
Mahindra And Mahindra Ltd	0.53%
PB FINTECH Ltd	0.52%
Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd	0.49%
TRENT Ltd	0.46%
Others	10.04%

GROUP INCOME FUND

SFIN No. ULGF005010118GRPINCUND133

ABOUT THE FUND				PORTFOLIO AS ON 27-Feb-2026		SECTORAL ALLOCATION	
OBJECTIVE				SECURITIES		HOLDINGS	
This fund aims to provide stable returns by investing in inassets with relatively low to moderate level of risk. Thefund will invest in fixed income securities such as Govt.Securities, Corporate Bonds & any other fixed incomeinvestments along with Money Market Instruments for liquidity.				MONEY MARKET INSTRUMENTS & NCA		4.17%	
				SECURITIES		HOLDINGS	
				GOVERNMENT SECURITIES		73.32%	
				6.90% Gsec 15/04/2065		16.05%	
				0% CS 22 APR 2037		14.59%	
				0% CS 19/12/2029		14.09%	
				6.01% Gsec 21 July 2030		10.81%	
				7.10% GOI Sovereign Green Bond 27/01/2028		7.60%	
				0% CS 22/02/2030		6.10%	
				0% CS 17/06/2033		1.92%	
Fund Manager Details				7.24% Gsec 18 Aug 2055		1.54%	
Fund Manager		No. Of Funds Managed		8.00% GOI OIL Bond 23/03/2026		0.62%	
		Equity	Debt	Hybrid			
Vedant Heda		-	4	7			
Shobit Gupta		-	4	7			
Niraj Kumar		6	4	7			
ASSET ALLOCATION				SECURITIES		HOLDINGS	
Composition				CORPORATE DEBT		22.51%	
Cash and Money Market		Min.	Max.	Actual	8.90% BHARTI TELECOM Ltd 05/11/2031		6.59%
Fixed Income Instruments		0.00%	40.00%	4.17%	8.40% Cholamandalam Investment And Fin Co Ltd 09/08/2028		6.46%
Equities		60.00%	100.00%	95.83%	7.27% NABARD 23 Feb 2029		6.26%
		0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	7.89% Bajaj Housing Finance Ltd 14/07/2034		3.20%
RISK RETURN PROFILE				Debt Rating Profile			
Risk		Low To Moderate		6.07%			
Return		High		24.99%			
				68.94%			
DATE OF INCEPTION				■ AAA ■ SOV ■ AA+ ■ Others			
31st March 2019							
FUND PERFORMANCE as on 27-Feb-2026				BENCHMARK COMPARISON (CAGR RETURN)			
Returns since Publication of NAV				Since Inception			
Absolute Return		76.39%		8.55%			
CAGR Return		8.55%		7.20%			
				5 years			
				4 years			
				3 years			
				2 years			
				1 year			
				6 months			
				1 month			
NAV & AUM as on 27-Feb-2026				■ FUTURE GROUP INCOME FUND ■ Benchmark			
NAV		AUM (In Lakhs)		8.55%			
17.6392		321.12		7.20%			
				7.00%			
				6.16%			
				7.11%			
				6.18%			
				8.42%			
				7.25%			
				7.98%			
				6.56%			
				8.20%			
				5.40%			
				4.23%			
				1.93%			
				1.60%			
				0.73%			
Modified Duration (In Years)				Benchmark :Nifty Composite Debt Index 100%			
5.61							
ASSET ALLOCATION				FUND - NAV			
■ Money Market & NCA, 4.17%				Feb-20			
■ NCD, 22.51%				May-20			
■ GSEC, 73.32%				Aug-20			
				Nov-20			
				Feb-21			
				May-21			
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				Feb-26			